

SECTION 1 — IMPORT-READY SOURCE FILE

AP World History: Modern Free-Response Practice Exam 11

APWH-SAQ11-001

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 1 — The Global Tapestry

Period: c. 1200–1450

Theme: ENV — Humans and the Environment

Historical Reasoning: Mixed Historical Reasoning

Source Type: Secondary text source

Prompt:

Source 1: Historian Claire Redbird, “Cahokia and the Mississippi Valley,” modern historical interpretation, 2021.

“Cahokia’s growth depended on the ability of leaders to organize people, food, ritual spaces, and regional exchange around the Mississippi River system. Its platform mounds, plazas, and surrounding agricultural settlements suggest that political and religious authority were tied to control over labor and maize production.”

Source 2: Historian Thomas Avery, “Urbanism without Old World Models,” modern historical interpretation, 2019.

“Mississippian centers such as Cahokia challenge the assumption that cities must depend on writing, draft animals, or centralized bureaucracies. Cahokia’s influence came from ceremonial authority, regional networks, and environmental adaptation rather than from the same institutions found in Afro-Eurasian states.”

- (a) Identify one difference between the two historians’ interpretations of Cahokia.
- (b) Describe one specific historical development that could be used to support one of the interpretations.
- (c) Explain one way Cahokia or Mississippian societies were similar to or different from another society during c. 1200–1450.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Identifies a clear difference between the interpretations, such as Source 1 emphasizing organized labor, food production, and political-religious authority while Source 2 emphasizes urban influence without writing, draft animals, or Afro-Eurasian-style bureaucracy.
- (b) 1 point: Describes a relevant development, such as platform mound construction, maize agriculture, plazas, regional exchange, settlement hierarchy, ritual authority, or the use of the Mississippi River system.
- (c) 1 point: Explains a valid similarity or difference with another society, such as Song China, Mali, Great Zimbabwe, Angkor, the Mexica, or Polynesian societies, using specific evidence about agriculture, environment, cities, state authority, religion, labor organization, or exchange networks.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should avoid judging Cahokia only by the standards of Afro-Eurasian empires. Strong responses should explain how environmental adaptation, maize agriculture, ceremonial

authority, and regional exchange supported urban development. For part (c), the best answers compare a specific feature, such as agricultural surplus, monumental construction, religious authority, or administrative organization.

Expected Points:

3

APWH-SAQ11-002

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 4 — Transoceanic Interconnections

Period: c. 1450–1750

Theme: ECN — Economic Systems

Historical Reasoning: Sourcing / POV / Purpose / Audience

Source Type: Primary text source

Prompt:

Source: Report from a royal harbor official in Ayutthaya to the Siamese court, 1645. This excerpt is original but modeled on early modern Southeast Asian port administration.

“Ships from China, Japan, Java, Persia, and the lands of the Franks have arrived this season. The royal warehouses should purchase fine cloth, metals, and weapons before private brokers raise the price. Foreign captains ask for safe lodging and permission to trade, but they must remember that commerce in this port exists by the king’s favor. Malay pilots, Chinese interpreters, and local tax collectors are all needed if the harbor is to remain prosperous and orderly.”

(a) Identify the likely purpose of the report.

(b) Explain how the report reflects one feature of maritime commerce in Southeast Asia during c. 1450–1750.

(c) Explain one limitation of the source as evidence for the experiences of foreign merchants in Ayutthaya.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

(a) 1 point: Identifies a plausible purpose, such as informing the court about arriving ships, recommending royal control over purchases, regulating foreign merchants, organizing port officials, or protecting royal revenue.

(b) 1 point: Explains a relevant feature of Southeast Asian maritime commerce, such as cosmopolitan port cities, royal monopolies or court-supervised trade, use of interpreters and pilots, participation of Chinese, Japanese, Malay, Persian, and European merchants, or state efforts to tax and regulate commerce.

(c) 1 point: Explains a valid limitation, such as the source representing a royal official rather than foreign merchants, dockworkers, women traders, enslaved people, local brokers, or sailors; or noting that it emphasizes royal authority and order while minimizing merchant grievances or informal trade.

Model Guidance:

A strong response should use the source’s point of view as a court official concerned with revenue, order, and royal authority. The report shows that Southeast Asian ports were not passive stops for foreign traders; rulers and officials actively managed commercial exchange. Strong answers should also recognize that the source tells us more about state regulation than about the full experience of merchants or laborers.

Expected Points:

3

APWH-SAQ11-003

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 8 — Cold War and Decolonization

Period: c. 1900–present

Theme: GOV — Governance

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Non-text source

Prompt:

Source: Description of an airlift operations map used by Western officials during the Berlin Blockade, 1948–1949.

The map shows West Berlin surrounded by the Soviet occupation zone. Three air corridors connect airfields in western Germany to West Berlin. Arrows labeled “food,” “coal,” “medicine,” and “mail” point into the city. A small chart beside the map shows monthly increases in cargo deliveries. Notes below the map read: “Road and rail routes blocked. Air supply continues. Civilian morale and allied credibility depend on regular delivery.”

- (a) Identify one goal of the airlift suggested by the described map.
- (b) Explain one cause of the Berlin Blockade.
- (c) Explain one way the event shown in the map reflected broader Cold War tensions.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Identifies a valid goal, such as supplying West Berlin, maintaining civilian morale, resisting Soviet pressure, preserving Western access to the city, demonstrating allied credibility, or preventing West Berlin from being forced into the Soviet sphere.
- (b) 1 point: Explains a valid cause of the Berlin Blockade, such as disagreement over Germany’s postwar future, currency reform in the western zones, Soviet concern over Western consolidation, occupation-zone rivalry, or growing mistrust between former wartime allies.
- (c) 1 point: Explains a broader Cold War pattern, such as containment, competition over divided Germany, ideological rivalry, crisis diplomacy short of direct war, alliance formation, or conflict between Soviet and Western spheres of influence.

Model Guidance:

A strong response should interpret the map as evidence of Cold War crisis management. The blocked road and rail routes, air corridors, cargo labels, and concern for morale all show that the crisis was political as well as logistical. Strong answers should connect Berlin to the broader division of Europe after World War II.

Expected Points:

3

APWH-DBQ11-001

Section: DBQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 6 — Consequences of Industrialization

Period: c. 1750–1900

Theme: ECN — Economic Systems

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Seven-document set

Prompt:

Evaluate the extent to which European imperial economic policies transformed Southeast Asian societies from c. 1830 to 1900.

Document 1

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Report from a Dutch colonial administrator to officials in Batavia, 1835, Java.

Source Type: Colonial administrative report.

“The cultivation system has increased delivery of coffee and sugar to government warehouses. Village heads are responsible for assigning land and labor, and the treasury benefits from predictable production. Some districts complain of hunger when too much attention is given to export crops, but the system teaches discipline and makes the colony useful to the kingdom.”

Sourcing cues: Colonial official defending state-directed export production; emphasizes revenue and order while minimizing local hardship.

Document 2

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Petition from Javanese village elders to a district official, 1848, Central Java.

Source Type: Local petition.

“Our wet-rice fields have long fed our households, paid local obligations, and supported ceremonies. Now laborers are called away to plant cane and carry loads for the government crop. When rains fail, the village has little reserve. We ask that rice fields not be taken at the season when food must be secured.”

Sourcing cues: Local village perspective; emphasizes subsistence, labor burdens, and disruption caused by export-crop demands.

Document 3

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Export summary from a British commercial office, 1860–1890, Rangoon.

Source Type: Plain-text data table.

Selected Rice Exports from Lower Burma

Year Reported Pattern

1860 Rice exports increasing after expanded British control

1870 New canals and mills support larger shipments

1880 Delta lands brought into commercial rice production

1890 Rangoon becomes a major rice-exporting port

Note on the table: The report linked export growth to river transport, land clearing, credit, and demand from overseas markets.

Sourcing cues: British commercial perspective; highlights export growth but does not show debt, labor conditions, or ecological effects.

Document 4

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Memorandum from a French official in Cochinchina, 1882, Saigon.

Source Type: Colonial memorandum.

“Roads, canals, and schools will allow the colony to produce more efficiently and to understand French methods. Vietnamese clerks trained in our language can assist administration, but education must remain practical and loyal. The purpose is not to create critics of France but useful intermediaries for agriculture, taxation, and order.”

Sourcing cues: French colonial official; supports infrastructure and limited education to strengthen administration and production.

Document 5

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Description of a colonial infrastructure map of mainland Southeast Asia, 1895.

Source Type: Described map.

The map shows rail and river routes connecting inland rice, teak, tin, and rubber-producing districts to ports such as Rangoon, Saigon, Singapore, and Bangkok. European-controlled territories are shaded differently from Siam, which remains formally independent. Telegraph lines run beside several rail routes. A legend marks “export zones,” “customs stations,” “plantation districts,” and “mining areas.”

Sourcing cues: Colonial cartographic source; presents infrastructure as orderly economic development while highlighting export corridors and imperial boundaries.

Document 6

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Letter from a Chinese merchant in Singapore to a relative in Fujian, 1896.

Source Type: Private letter.

“Tin mines and rubber gardens bring profit to those who can supply workers, food, and credit. Men from our district arrive each month, some with contracts, some with debts, and some hoping to open shops. British law protects trade when it suits officials, but taxes, licenses, and police rules remind us that this is not our country.”

Sourcing cues: Diaspora merchant perspective; shows opportunity, migration, credit networks, and colonial regulation.

Document 7

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Editorial from a Filipino reform newspaper, 1898, Manila.

Source Type: Newspaper editorial.

“The colony has been told that roads, schools, and commerce are gifts of civilization. Yet land taxes grow, friar estates remain powerful, and local voices are treated as disorder when they ask for representation. If commerce expands but dignity is denied, the educated youth will no longer confuse export wealth with justice.”

Sourcing cues: Reformist colonial newspaper; links economic change to political criticism and educated nationalist sentiment.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 7

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point by making a historically defensible claim that evaluates the extent to which European imperial economic policies transformed Southeast Asian societies from c. 1830 to 1900. A strong thesis should establish a line of reasoning, such as arguing that imperial policies transformed agriculture, labor, infrastructure, migration, education, and export production while preserving some local hierarchies and provoking social hardship and political criticism.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing a broader historical context relevant to nineteenth-century imperialism in Southeast Asia, such as industrial demand for raw materials, European maritime power, the expansion of colonial states, steamships and telegraphs, plantation agriculture, global commodity markets, missionary and educational activity, Chinese and Indian migration, or the competition among European empires.

Evidence from the Documents — 2 points: Earns 1 point by accurately using the content of at least three documents to address the prompt. Earns 2 points by using at least six documents to support an argument about export crops, village labor, commercial rice, infrastructure, education, migration, credit, colonial regulation, or reformist criticism.

Evidence Beyond the Documents — 1 point: Earns the point by using at least one specific piece of relevant outside evidence not found in the documents, such as the Dutch Cultivation System, British conquest of Burma, French Indochina, the Suez Canal, Singapore as an entrepôt, Chinese labor migration to Malaya, the Philippine Revolution, Siamese modernization under Mongkut or Chulalongkorn, or rubber and tin exports.

Sourcing / Analysis of Documents — 1 point: Earns the point by explaining how or why the point of view, purpose, audience, or historical situation of at least three documents is relevant to the argument. Effective examples include explaining why colonial officials emphasized revenue and order, why village elders focused on subsistence, why commercial tables omit social costs, why French officials limited education, why maps present export corridors as progress, why merchants emphasized opportunity and regulation, or why reform newspapers linked economic change to political demands.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by demonstrating a more complex understanding of imperial economic transformation. This may include explaining that imperial policies created new infrastructure and export wealth while increasing labor burdens and dependency, that migrants and local intermediaries could benefit while rural communities suffered, or that economic change helped produce new political criticism and nationalism.

Model Guidance:

A strong DBQ could argue that European imperial economic policies greatly transformed Southeast Asian societies by reorganizing agriculture around export crops, expanding commercial rice and plantation production, building infrastructure, increasing migration, and strengthening colonial administration. Documents 1, 3, 4, and 5 support arguments about state-directed production, export corridors, and infrastructure. Documents 2, 6, and 7 show social costs, migrant opportunity, colonial regulation, and political criticism. Outside evidence could include the Dutch Cultivation System, British Burma, French Indochina, Singapore, the Philippine Revolution, Chinese migration to Malaya, or Siamese reforms. Strong sourcing should compare colonial administrators, village elders, commercial observers, diaspora merchants, cartographers, and reformist newspaper writers.

Expected Points:

7

APWH-LEQ11-001

Section: LEQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 9 — Globalization

Period: c. 1900–present

Theme: SIO — Social Interactions and Organization

Historical Reasoning: Continuity and Change Over Time

Source Type: Broad historical prompt with introductory statement

Prompt:

During the twentieth century, cities expanded rapidly in many regions as industrialization, decolonization, migration, war, state planning, and global economic change reshaped where people lived and worked. Urban growth created new opportunities but also produced housing shortages, informal settlements, pollution, labor struggles, and new cultural forms.

Evaluate the extent to which urbanization changed social structures in the period c. 1900 to the present.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 6

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point by making a historically defensible claim that evaluates the extent to which urbanization changed social structures from c. 1900 to the present. A strong thesis should establish a line of reasoning about change, continuity, or both.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing a broader context relevant to twentieth-century urbanization, such as industrialization, rural-to-urban migration, decolonization, population growth, war and displacement, globalization, state-led development, transportation networks, housing policy, or the expansion of wage labor.

Evidence — 2 points: Earns 1 point by identifying at least two specific pieces of relevant evidence, such as Mexico City’s growth, Lagos or Nairobi urbanization, Mumbai, Shanghai, Cairo, favelas in Brazil, apartheid townships, Soviet planned cities, migrant labor dormitories, informal economies, urban labor unions, or public housing programs. Earns 2 points by using at least two pieces of evidence to support an argument about social structural change.

Historical Reasoning — 1 point: Earns the point by using continuity and change over time to explain how urbanization changed social structures and what continuities persisted. Strong responses might explain changes in class formation, gender roles, labor organization, education, youth culture, informal economies, or political protest, while also noting continuities in inequality, segregation, rural ties, family networks, or migrant marginalization.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by demonstrating a nuanced understanding of urbanization. This may include explaining that urbanization created new middle classes and working classes while also expanding informal settlements, that states attempted to plan urban life but migrants often built their own networks, or that urbanization affected men, women, migrants, and elites differently across regions.

Model Guidance:

A strong LEQ should not simply say that cities became larger. It should explain how urban growth changed social structures. Useful evidence might include favelas in Brazil, Mexico City, Lagos, Nairobi, Cairo, Mumbai, Shanghai, apartheid townships, Soviet planned cities, migrant labor systems, public housing, informal markets, and urban labor movements. Strong responses should balance change and continuity, showing how urbanization reshaped class, gender, work, politics, education, and culture while inequality, segregation, and rural family networks often persisted.

Expected Points:

6

SECTION 2 — SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — DO NOT IMPORT

SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — APWH-FRQ11

· APWH-SAQ11-001: Unit 1 — The Global Tapestry; c. 1200–1450; North America / Cahokia,

Mississippian societies, Mississippi River valley, maize agriculture, platform mounds, plazas, and regional exchange; secondary text source with two modern historians; source perspectives contrast organized labor, food production, political-religious authority, and riverine power with urbanism without writing, draft animals, or Afro-Eurasian-style bureaucracy; historical development is Cahokia's urban growth and Mississippian environmental adaptation; reasoning path compares explanations of non-Afro-Eurasian urban authority and evaluates environment, ritual, labor, and exchange; misconception targeted: complex urban societies required writing, draft animals, or Old World-style bureaucratic states.

· APWH-SAQ11-002: Unit 4 — Transoceanic Interconnections; c. 1450–1750; Ayutthaya / Siamese court, Southeast Asian port commerce, Chinese, Japanese, Javanese, Persian, Malay, and European merchants; primary text source is an original royal harbor official report; source perspective is a court official managing royal warehouses, foreign merchants, interpreters, pilots, tax collectors, and state-supervised commerce; historical development is cosmopolitan Southeast Asian port trade and royal regulation of maritime commerce; reasoning path focuses on purpose, port-state commercial management, and source limitation for foreign merchant experiences; misconception targeted: Southeast Asian ports were passive spaces controlled by foreign traders rather than actively managed by local states.

· APWH-SAQ11-003: Unit 8 — Cold War and Decolonization; c. 1900–present; Berlin, Germany, Western occupation zones, Soviet occupation zone, Berlin Blockade, and airlift corridors; non-text source type is a described airlift operations map with cargo chart; visual/data/map pattern includes West Berlin surrounded by Soviet zone, air corridors, cargo arrows for food/coal/medicine/mail, blocked roads and rails, and rising monthly deliveries; historical development is Berlin Blockade and Airlift as Cold War crisis short of direct war; reasoning path is causation from postwar occupation disputes and currency reform to Cold War confrontation; misconception targeted: Cold War conflict happened only through military battles rather than logistical, diplomatic, and symbolic crises.

· APWH-DBQ11-001: Unit 6 — Consequences of Industrialization; c. 1750–1900; Southeast Asia including Java, Batavia, Central Java, Lower Burma, Rangoon, Cochinchina, Saigon, Singapore, Siam, Malaya, Fujian diaspora networks, and Manila; DBQ topic is European imperial economic policies transforming Southeast Asian societies from c. 1830 to 1900; document types include Dutch colonial administrative report, Javanese village petition, British rice export table, French colonial memorandum, described infrastructure/export-zone map, Chinese merchant private letter, and Filipino reform newspaper editorial; document perspectives include colonial officials, village elders, commercial offices, French administrators, colonial cartographers, diaspora merchants, and reformist journalists; main argument paths include cultivation systems, export crops, subsistence disruption, rice commercialization, infrastructure, limited education, migration, credit networks, colonial regulation, reformist criticism, and emerging nationalism; outside evidence possibilities include Dutch Cultivation System, British Burma, French Indochina, Suez Canal, Singapore entrepôt trade, Chinese labor migration to Malaya, Philippine Revolution, Siamese reforms under Mongkut or Chulalongkorn, rubber exports, and tin mining; sourcing opportunities include colonial revenue defense, village subsistence concerns, commercial-data omissions, administrative education goals, map portrayal of export corridors, merchant opportunity under regulation, and newspaper critique of commerce without rights.

· APWH-LEQ11-001: Unit 9 — Globalization; c. 1900–present; transregional urbanization in Latin America, Africa, South Asia, East Asia, Middle East, Soviet bloc, and apartheid South Africa; LEQ topic is urbanization changing social structures from c. 1900 to present; historical reasoning process is continuity and change over time; evidence categories include Mexico City, Lagos, Nairobi, Mumbai, Shanghai, Cairo, Brazilian favelas, apartheid townships, Soviet planned cities, migrant labor dormitories, informal economies, labor unions, public housing, youth culture, gendered work, and rural-to-urban migration; complexity path weighs new working and middle classes, informal settlements, state planning, gender changes, labor politics, and cultural forms against continuities in

inequality, segregation, rural ties, family networks, and migrant marginalization; misconception targeted: urbanization only means population growth rather than deep changes in class, labor, gender, politics, culture, and inequality.